



b. 1947 · Harvard Business School professor emeritus.

*"Most change efforts fail for lack of urgency."*

## THE WHY THAT DROVE THE WORK

Kotter sought to explain why most change efforts fail and what distinguishes the few that succeed, concluding that change is led, not merely managed.

## INTELLECTUAL FOUNDATION

From extensive study of corporate change programmes, he distilled a recurring pattern of failure and a corresponding eight-step process for success.

## FRAMEWORKS ANCHORED IN THIS COURSE

He anchors Kotter's 8 Steps in Unit 5's change-as-a-motor Slibrary.

## HOW THE IDEAS OPERATIONALISE

His process operationalises as a sequence beginning with urgency and a guiding coalition and ending with anchoring change in the culture.

## LIMITATIONS & CRITIQUE

The linear eight-step model can feel rigid for continuous or emergent change, and urgency can be manufactured cynically.

## ENDURING IMPACT

Kotter's work is among the most widely used change-management frameworks in business and the public sector.

## ON THE SAME PANEL (UNIT 5)

John Boyd · Giant 2

Clayton Christensen · Giant 3

Dave Snowden · Giant 21

Donald Miller · Giant 23

## SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Kotter, J.P. (1996) Leading Change. Boston: HBS Press.

Kotter, J.P. (1995) 'Leading change: Why transformation efforts fail', Harvard Business Review, 73(2).